

UNIT 4

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks Each)

Understanding Existence

Q1. What is meant by 'existence'?

Answer: Existence is everything that is — all material things, all living beings, and the space in which they exist, all functioning together as one interrelated whole. It is comprehensive, interconnected and self-organised — not a random collection of separate objects.

Q2. What is the partial (fragmented) view of nature?

Answer: The partial view sees nature as separate objects — rocks, trees, animals, humans — unrelated to each other; treats humans as separate from or superior to nature, free to exploit it; studies each thing in isolation (a tree, a river, a mineral) without seeing the relationship between them; and leads to fragmented, short-term decisions such as pollution, deforestation and resource depletion.

Q3. What is the comprehensive view of nature?

Answer: The comprehensive view sees nature as one interconnected, self-organised whole in which every part is related to every other part; understands the human being as an integral part of nature, participating in it rather than standing outside it; recognises four distinct orders (Material, Bio, Animal, Human), each with its own role, working together; and leads to harmony, sustainability and right participation — the basis for a value-based life.

Q4. Give two examples of the real consequences of the partial vs. comprehensive view.

Answer: (1) Deforestation for short-term profit — the partial view sees trees only as timber/land value, while the comprehensive view sees them sustaining soil, the water cycle, animal life and climate. (2) River pollution by industry — the partial view sees the river only as a waste-disposal channel, while the comprehensive view sees it as part of a living system supporting agriculture, drinking water and biodiversity. (Other valid examples: overuse of chemical fertilisers; species extinction.)

The Four Orders of Nature

Q5. Name the four orders of nature with their Hindi names.

Answer: (1) Material Order (Padarth Avastha), (2) Bio / Plant Order (Prana Avastha), (3) Animal Order (Jeevan Avastha), and (4) Human Order (Jeeva Avastha). All of existence can be comprehensively understood in terms of these four orders, each nested within and building upon the one before it.

Q6. Describe the Material Order with examples.

Answer: The Material Order is matter that exists but does not grow or self-organise on its own — it has no capacity for self-organisation or growth, and obeys only physical and chemical laws. Examples: soil, water, air, minerals, rocks. It is the foundation on which all other orders depend.

Q7. Describe the Bio Order with examples.

Answer: The Bio Order has self-organisation in growth — the defining capability of plants. It draws on material-order elements (soil, water, air) to grow itself, and reproduces and sustains itself, but cannot move or sense the way animals do. Examples: trees, crops, flowers, algae. It directly sustains the animal and human orders above it.

Q8. Describe the Animal Order with examples.

Answer: The Animal Order has self-organisation in growth plus self-organisation in self-preservation. It has instinct, sense-perception and mobility, and acts to preserve itself — seeking food and avoiding danger. Its behaviour is governed by instinct, largely fixed by nature and not by choice. Examples: cattle, birds, fish, insects.

Q9. Describe the Human Order with examples.

Answer: The Human Order has self-organisation in growth, self-preservation, and self-evolution. It has reasoning, imagination and the ability to choose, and can improve its understanding and conduct over a lifetime. It is the only order that can consciously understand and choose to live in harmony with the rest of nature.

Q10. How is each higher order related to the ones below it?

Answer: Each higher order includes the properties of the ones below it and adds one capability of its own — a human being still has a material body and biological processes, plus self-awareness. Each order needs the order(s) below it and contributes to the order(s) above it: the material order provides the basis for the bio order, the bio order sustains the animal and human orders, and the human order can understand this whole and choose to nurture it (right participation).

Q11. What is an 'order' in nature?

Answer: An 'order' means a class of units sharing a common characteristic activity — the material order (units with physical existence only, no growth or self-repair: rocks, water, metals, air), the bio/plant order (units with growth, self-repair and reproduction but no free movement: trees, crops), the animal order (units that additionally have mobility, instinct and sensation), and the human order (units that additionally have self-awareness and choice). Understanding these four orders is the basis for understanding harmony in nature as a whole.

Q12. Explain the 'one tree, four orders' example.

Answer: In any tree, all four orders are visibly at work at the same time: the soil, water, minerals and air the tree draws on are the Material Order; the tree itself — growing, photosynthesising, reproducing via seeds — is the Bio Order; the birds nesting in it, insects pollinating it and squirrels feeding on it are the Animal Order; and the human being — resting in its shade, studying its biology, deciding whether to protect or cut it — is the Human Order. A partial view sees only 'a tree'; a comprehensive view sees an entire self-organised system in harmony.

Nature as Units and Space

Q13. What is meant by nature as a collection of units?

Answer: Nature can be understood as a collection of units, all existing in space. The units are of four kinds: material units (soil, water, air, rocks), pranic / bio units (plants), animal units, and human units (co-existence of Self and Body). Each unit can be understood in terms of its constitution, its participation with other units of the same and other orders, and its innateness (its characteristic nature). All the units are related to one another and co-exist in harmony.

Q14. State the sequence of abundance among the four orders of nature.

Answer: The Material Order is the most abundant (soil, water and air are available in the largest quantity), followed by the Bio Order (plants), then the Animal Order, and the Human Order is the least abundant. As we move up the orders, abundance decreases — like a pyramid, with the material order at the base. The lower orders serve the higher ones, so there is naturally more of what is needed at the base: material → bio → animal → human.

Q15. Differentiate between units and space in terms of size and activity.

Answer: **Size:** every unit is limited in size — big or small, from an atom to the largest star — whereas space has no size; it is all-pervading and unlimited. **Activity:** every unit is active — engaged in a definite, continuous activity (an electron revolves, a plant grows, an animal moves) — whereas space is not active; it does not do anything, does not interact with anything, and is not affected by anything. Space simply accommodates all the units.

Q16. What is self-regulation in nature? Give one example.

Answer: Self-regulation in nature means the four orders inherently maintain harmony and balance among themselves without any external control — each unit takes only as much as it needs, and the cycles of nature (water cycle, food chains, nutrient cycles) run automatically. **Example:** in a forest, if the

deer population grows, the food chain naturally keeps it in check; a predator such as a tiger kills only as much prey as it needs for food — animals never over-consume or hoard.

Q17. What is meant by 'existence is co-existence'?

Answer: Existence is the co-existence of all units in space — units related to one another in mutual fulfilment. Every unit, from an atom to a human being, is connected to and depends on other units; nothing exists in isolation. There is no conflict in existence at the level of nature — the four orders are inherently in harmony. To be in existence is to co-exist: I exist along with, and in relationship with, everything else.

Mutual Fulfilment in Nature

Q18. What is meant by mutual fulfilment among the four orders of nature?

Answer: Each order is fulfilling for the others in a continuous cycle: the soil (material order) provides minerals and water; plants (bio order) grow using soil, air and sunlight; animals and humans eat plants and breathe oxygen; and waste and remains return nutrients to the soil — so the cycle continues. Nothing is wasted and nothing stands alone; the fulfilment flows in both directions between the orders.

Q19. Explain the role of animals and birds in the mutual fulfilment of the bio order.

Answer: Animals and birds help the bio order in three main ways: (1) **Pollination** — bees, butterflies and birds carry pollen from flower to flower, enabling plants to reproduce (the honeybee collects nectar for itself while pollinating the flower in return). (2) **Seed dispersal** — birds eat fruits and disperse the seeds over a wide area, helping new plants grow. (3) **Manure** — animal waste returns nutrients to the soil, enriching it for plants. In return, plants provide animals and birds with food, shelter and oxygen.

Q20. 'Harmony does not mean sameness.' Explain.

Answer: Harmony in nature does not mean that all orders are the same — each distinct order has its own characteristic activity and plays its part in a way that supports and completes the others. The material, bio, animal and human orders are different, but their differences are complementary. Disturbing one order significantly (e.g., destroying soil health or forests) affects the fulfilment of every other order, including the human order.

The Need and Process of Inner Evolution

Q21. Why is knowing something intellectually not enough?

Answer: Most of us know in principle that honesty is good or that nature should be respected, yet our actual living often does not match — we still copy in exams under pressure, litter or waste water casually, and chase possessions over people. The gap exists because information is not the same as realization: we may have heard or read the right thing, but we have not explored and verified it within ourselves, so it stays as borrowed information rather than our own understanding. That verification is what inner evolution provides.

Q22. What is inner evolution?

Answer: Inner evolution is the process by which a human being moves from borrowed beliefs and assumptions to a self-verified, natural understanding of what is right — and then naturally lives accordingly. It is natural, not forced (like physical growth, understanding can naturally deepen); it happens through exploration, not instruction (you verify things through your own natural acceptance); it is universal (the same process works for every human being); and it leads to consistent living — no gap between knowing and doing.

Q23. Name the three steps of the process of inner evolution.

Answer: (1) **Self-Exploration** — a dialogue within yourself, questioning and examining what you assume to be true, using your own natural acceptance as the check. (2) **Self-Awareness** — becoming clearly aware of the difference between what you truly are (the Self) and the physical body, and their distinct needs. (3) **Self-Evaluation** — honestly assessing your own thoughts, feelings and actions

against what you have understood, and correcting the gap. It is a continuous, deepening cycle, not a one-time event.

Q24. What is self-exploration? Give an example.

Answer: Self-exploration is a dialogue within yourself — examining the beliefs, values and assumptions you have accepted from parents, teachers, media or society, and checking whether they are naturally acceptable to you. It works by asking yourself 'why' about what you believe instead of accepting it automatically, comparing it against your natural acceptance (what feels right on reflection, not just what is convenient), and noticing the difference between 'I was told this' and 'I have verified this for myself'.

Example: you were taught 'more money means more happiness' — self-exploration means pausing to ask whether more money has actually made the wealthiest people you know happier, or whether something else is at play.

Q25. What is self-awareness? Give an example.

Answer: Self-awareness is becoming clearly aware that 'I' (the conscious Self) am different from 'my body' — and that each has distinct needs: the Self wants happiness and prosperity, while the body wants comfort and physical facility. It means recognising the Self as the 'seer, feeler and doer' — the one who is aware — distinct from the body it uses as an instrument, which helps you identify whose need you are actually fulfilling in a given choice. **Example:** you skip studying to watch one more video, telling yourself 'I'll feel good' — self-awareness asks whether this is fulfilling the Self (real, lasting satisfaction) or only the body's momentary comfort.

Q26. What is self-evaluation? Give an example.

Answer: Self-evaluation is honestly checking your own thoughts, feelings and actions against your now-verified understanding — and consciously working to close any gap you find. It works by asking, at the end of a day or decision, whether your behaviour matched what you understand to be right; by being honest rather than self-defensive; and by identifying one specific, small correction rather than a vague resolution to 'be better'. **Example:** you value honesty but exaggerated a story to impress friends — self-evaluation means noticing this gap honestly and choosing the next opportunity to speak more truthfully.

Q27. Why is inner evolution a continuous, deepening cycle?

Answer: The three steps feed into each other, again and again: exploring a belief (exploration) sharpens your sense of Self vs. body (awareness); that clarity gives you a standard to check your actions against (evaluation); and what you discover in evaluation raises new questions — sending you back to explore further. Each round deepens your understanding over time; the three steps are not a one-time checklist.

Q28. State any two misconceptions about self-exploration.

Answer: (1) Self-exploration is NOT blindly accepting what elders, teachers or media say — it is questioning it and checking it against your own natural acceptance. (2) It is NOT rejecting everything just to be different or rebellious — it is openly examining ideas; some will be verified as true and some won't. (3) It is NOT following only what feels good in the moment — it checks what brings lasting, real satisfaction at the level of the Self, not the body. (4) It is NOT a one-time decision — it is an ongoing dialogue you return to as you grow.

Activities of the Self — Realization, Understanding, Contemplation

Q29. Name the three activities of the Self awakened through inner evolution.

Answer: (1) **Understanding** — clarity in the intellect about 'what is true', a conceptual, verbal grasp that you can explain in words. (2) **Realization** — the same truth becoming your own direct experience, felt within the Self, beyond words. (3) **Contemplation** — sustained reflection connecting what is understood and realized to your own living and participation. Together they lead to a comprehensive, livable knowledge of existence.

Q30. Differentiate between understanding and realization, with the sugar example.

Answer: Understanding is reading that sugar is sweet — you can define sweetness, describe its chemistry and quote what others have said, entirely in words and concepts; it happens in the intellect. **Realization** is actually tasting the sugar — the sweetness becomes your own direct experience; no words are required and no one can argue you out of it once tasted; it happens in the Self. A student can 'understand' that honesty is important and score full marks explaining why — yet still copy in an exam; realization is when honesty is felt as one's own value.

Q31. What is contemplation? Explain with the gravity example.

Answer: Contemplation is sustained, deliberate reflection connecting what is understood and realized to one's own living and participation — asking: 'Given what I understand and have realized, what does this mean for how I act and participate?' **Example:** you understand gravity as a force of mutual attraction and can state Newton's law (understanding); you feel your own weight, feel a fall, feel the pull — it is no longer just a formula (realization); and you contemplate — you secure loose objects at height, design stairs with railings, and walk carefully near edges. Contemplation shapes actual conduct.

Q32. What is meant by 'realization of co-existence'?

Answer: It is recognizing directly — not merely as an intellectual idea — that 'I' and 'Nature' are not separate: my existence is already interconnected with the material, bio and human orders around me. It can be directly realized by observing one's own life closely: tracing everything that had to exist for you to be sitting where you are — the air you breathe, the food you ate, the people who built the room, your parents — and noticing that not one of these is truly separate from you.

Q33. Give examples of co-existence at three scales of everyday life.

Answer: (1) **Physical scale** — a tree cannot exist without soil, water, sunlight and air, and in turn releases the oxygen that sustains animal and human life. (2) **Family/social scale** — an individual exists only in relationship, as someone's child, sibling, friend or student; remove all the relationships and 'who I am' becomes unclear. (3) **Societal scale** — a farmer, teacher, doctor or engineer is not self-sufficient; society exists because each person's competence fulfils a need for everyone else. At every scale, existence works because units are mutually fulfilling, not competing to survive alone.

Q34. Distinguish between the fragmented view and the holistic view.

Answer: Fragmented view (before): nature is a resource to use up; 'me' vs. 'the environment' as separate; success means my gain regardless of the cost to others; ethics is an external rule imposed on me. **Holistic view (after):** nature is a web I am already part of; 'me' and 'existence' are in continuous co-existence; success includes the fulfilment of the whole I am part of; ethics arises naturally from realized understanding.

The Human Order's Unique Role and Responsibility

Q35. What is a human being in terms of the Self and the Body?

Answer: A human being is the co-existence of the Self (Jeevan — the conscious 'I') and the Body (Sharir — the material-biological unit). The Self is the conscious entity that understands, feels and chooses; the Body is the material instrument used by the Self. It is the Self which relates, decides and experiences; the Body acts on its instruction.

Q36. What is the human order's unique responsibility in nature?

Answer: Only the human order can ask 'why?' — a plant grows and an animal acts by disposition, but only a human being can question, evaluate and choose whether an action is right. Because we alone can understand harmony, we alone are responsible for preserving or disturbing it — the other orders participate automatically, while we participate consciously. Every professional decision — engineer, teacher, doctor — is a choice about sustaining or disrupting this harmony.

Q37. 'Harmony is a fact; participating in it is a choice.' Explain.

Answer: The material, plant and animal orders act spontaneously — they are automatically in harmony; a river does not choose to flow, a tree does not choose to grow towards light, and they cannot act otherwise, so there is no question of contradiction for them. The human order has consciousness (the ability to know self and existence) and choice (the freedom to select our actions) — so harmony for us is not automatic; it must be understood, willed and lived. Participation means choosing to act in line with the harmony that already exists.

Q38. What is the significance of education-sanskar for the human order?

Answer: The material, bio and animal orders are naturally in harmony by their innateness (self-regulation) — they need no teaching. The human order, having choice (the conscious Self with desire, thought and expectation), can either participate in harmony or be in contradiction. Therefore the human order needs education-sanskar: education to develop right understanding of harmony at all levels (self, family, society, nature/existence), and sanskar to develop the basic acceptances of living accordingly. With education-sanskar, humans can fulfil their unique role — enrichment, protection and right utilisation of nature — instead of exploiting it.

Q39. What is meant by right utilisation, enrichment and protection of nature?

Answer: These are the three aspects of the human order's participation in nature: **Protection** — safeguarding the continuity of nature (e.g., preventing deforestation, soil erosion, pollution of rivers). **Enrichment** — improving the quantity and quality of nature (e.g., planting trees, water harvesting, composting). **Right utilisation** — using natural resources according to real need, in limited quantity, for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body — not hoarding or wasting (using only as much water, food or electricity as is needed).

Human Participation in Harmony

Q40. Name the four kinds of human participation in harmony.

Answer: (1) **With the Self** — keeping body and self in harmony: sleep, discipline, honest self-evaluation instead of distraction or self-neglect. (2) **With the family / society** — right relationship: trust, respect and affection in the family; contributing to society rather than only taking from it. (3) **With nature** — using material and biological resources responsibly: not wasting water, food or electricity. (4) **With existence as a whole** — recognising that every choice ripples outward, and each small daily habit either supports or disturbs the larger balance.

Q41. Give two examples each of contradiction and participation in daily life.

Answer: Contradiction: leaving taps running / wasting water — vs. participation: using only what is needed, fixing leaks. Contradiction: littering the classroom or campus — vs. participation: disposing of waste responsibly, segregating it. Contradiction: ignoring family to stay on the phone — vs. participation: giving undivided time and attention at home. Contradiction: competing to put others down — vs. participation: competing while respecting and helping peers.

Q42. What is comprehensive knowledge about existence?

Answer: Comprehensive knowledge is seeing all four orders together with one's own responsible place among them. Existence is the co-existence of the four orders — Material, Bio/Plant, Animal and Human — related to one another in space, in a mutually fulfilling, interconnected, self-regulating, recyclable relationship, with the human being, once aware, willingly participating in and upholding that harmony. In short: four orders, one existence, your choice.

Q43. Why does the comprehensive understanding of existence matter?

Answer: (1) **Sustainability** — it guides responsible use of natural resources (water, energy, materials) instead of exploitative use. (2) **Family and social harmony** — it grounds trust, respect and cooperation in relationships at home, in hostel life and among peers. (3) **Personal well-being** — a person acting in contradiction with self and others lives in constant unease, while participation brings inner ease. (4) **Bridge to professional ethics** — one who can act in harmony personally can extend the same to one's

future profession (Module 5).

Illustrations from Everyday Life

Q44. Explain the honeybee and flower example.

Answer: The bee collects nectar for itself (its own need) while pollinating the flower in the process — the animal order fulfils the plant order without either being harmed. It shows that nature's orders participate in mutual fulfilment automatically: self-interest and the other's fulfilment are not in conflict in nature.

Q45. How does the human body show all four orders in one?

Answer: The body's atoms follow the material order; its cells grow and heal like the bio/plant order; its organs function like the animal order; and only you — the human order — can be aware of all this and choose. The human body is thus a living example of the co-existence of all four orders.

Q46. Explain the crop rotation vs. over-farming example.

Answer: A farmer who rotates crops and lets the soil recover is deliberately participating in nature's self-organising capacity (enrichment and protection of the material and bio orders). A farmer who repeatedly over-extracts from the same land is in contradiction with it — even though the harm (soil degradation) shows up only years later. The example shows the difference between participation and contradiction in the human order's relationship with nature.

Q47. Explain the shared family meal example.

Answer: An ordinary daily meal cooked and eaten together — everyone contributing, no one served last or left out — is trust, respect and relationship in practice. It shows the same harmony logic scaled up from the self to the family and society: mutual fulfilment at the level of relationship.

From the Reference Readings

Q48. What does E. F. Schumacher argue in 'Small is Beautiful' (1973)?

Answer: Schumacher argues that economics built on ever-larger scale and unlimited resource use loses sight of human-scale, sustainable living — ignoring mutual fulfilment with the material and bio orders. The book illustrates the consequences of a partial, exploitative view of nature.

Q49. What does Ivan Illich argue in 'Energy and Equity' (1974)?

Answer: Illich shows that, past a point, more energy consumption creates inequity rather than progress — a caution about over-drawing on the material order without balance.

Q50. What does Susan George examine in 'How the Other Half Dies' (1976)?

Answer: She examines how food scarcity is often not about nature's limits but about unequal, non-fulfilling participation among human beings — harmony broken within the human order itself.

SECTION B — Long/Descriptive Answer Questions (7 Marks Each)

The Four Orders of Nature

Q1. Explain the four orders of nature in detail, showing how each higher order includes the capabilities of the ones below it. Illustrate with the 'one tree' example.

Answer: All of existence can be comprehensively understood in terms of four orders, each nested within and building upon the one before it:

1. Material Order (Padarth Avastha): Matter that exists but does not grow or self-organise on its own. It obeys only physical and chemical laws and has no capacity for self-organisation or growth. Examples: soil, water, air, minerals, rocks. It is the foundation on which all other orders depend.

2. Bio Order (Prana Avastha): Adds self-organisation in growth — the defining capability of plants. It draws on material-order elements (soil, water, air) to grow itself, and reproduces and sustains itself, but cannot move or sense the way animals do. Examples: trees, crops, flowers, algae. It directly sustains the animal and human orders above it.

3. Animal Order (Jeevan Avastha): Adds self-organisation in self-preservation. Animals have instinct, sense-perception and mobility; they act to preserve themselves — seeking food and avoiding danger. Their behaviour is governed by instinct, largely fixed by nature, not choice. Examples: cattle, birds, fish, insects.

4. Human Order (Jeeva Avastha): Adds self-evolution — humans have reasoning, imagination and the ability to choose, and can improve their understanding and conduct over a lifetime. It is the only order that can consciously understand and choose to live in harmony with the rest of nature.

Each higher order includes the lower ones: a human being still has a material body and biological processes, plus self-awareness. Each order needs the orders below it and contributes to the orders above it: material provides the basis for bio, bio sustains animal and human, and the human order can understand the whole and choose to nurture it (right participation).

The one tree example: in any tree, all four orders are visibly at work at the same time — the soil, water, minerals and air it draws on (Material Order); the tree itself, growing, photosynthesising, reproducing via seeds (Bio Order); the birds nesting, insects pollinating, squirrels feeding on it (Animal Order); and the human being, resting in its shade, studying it, deciding whether to protect or cut it (Human Order). A partial view sees only 'a tree'; a comprehensive view sees an entire self-organised system in harmony.

The Need and Process of Inner Evolution

Q2. What is inner evolution? Explain its need and its three-step process (self-exploration, self-awareness, self-evaluation) with examples, and clarify the common misconceptions about self-exploration.

Answer: The need: most of us already know, in principle, that honesty is good or that nature should be respected, yet our actual living often does not match what we know — we still copy in exams under pressure, litter or waste water casually, and chase possessions over people. This gap exists because information is not the same as realization: we have heard or read the right thing, but we have not explored and verified it within ourselves, so it stays as borrowed information, not our own understanding.

Inner evolution is the process by which a human being moves from borrowed beliefs and assumptions to a self-verified, natural understanding of what is right — and then naturally lives accordingly. It is

natural (not forced), happens through exploration (not instruction), is universal (available to every human being), and leads to consistent living — no gap between knowing and doing.

Step 1 — Self-Exploration: a dialogue within yourself, examining the beliefs, values and assumptions accepted from parents, teachers, media or society, and checking whether they are naturally acceptable to you. Ask 'why' about what you believe instead of accepting it automatically; notice the difference between 'I was told this' and 'I have verified this for myself'. Example: you were taught 'more money means more happiness' — self-exploration means pausing to ask whether more money has actually made the wealthiest people you know happier.

Step 2 — Self-Awareness: becoming clearly aware that 'I' (the conscious Self) am different from 'my body', and that each has distinct needs — the Self wants happiness and prosperity, the body wants comfort and physical facility. Recognise the Self as the 'seer, feeler and doer', distinct from the body it uses as an instrument. Example: skipping study to watch one more video — self-awareness asks whether this fulfils the Self's lasting satisfaction or only the body's momentary comfort.

Step 3 — Self-Evaluation: honestly checking your own thoughts, feelings and actions against your now-verified understanding, and consciously working to close the gap — being honest rather than self-defensive, and identifying one specific, small correction rather than a vague resolution. Example: you value honesty but exaggerated a story to impress friends — evaluation means noticing the gap honestly and choosing the next opportunity to speak more truthfully.

It is a continuous, deepening cycle: exploring a belief sharpens your sense of Self vs. body; that clarity gives a standard to check your actions against; and what evaluation reveals sends you back to explore further. Worked example (group project dilemma): a teammate who hasn't contributed agrees to have his name included — exploration questions the assumption that submitting on time matters more than fairness; awareness sees that going along keeps the body comfortable but does not sit right with the Self; evaluation decides to talk to the teammate honestly before submission.

Misconceptions: self-exploration is NOT blindly accepting what elders, teachers or media say (it is questioning and checking against your own natural acceptance); it is NOT rejecting everything just to be rebellious (it is openly examining ideas — some will be verified as true, some won't); it is NOT following only what feels good in the moment (it checks for lasting, Self-level satisfaction); and it is NOT a one-time decision (it is an ongoing dialogue).

Realization, Understanding and Contemplation in the Self

Q3. Explain the three activities of the Self — Understanding, Realization and Contemplation — with suitable examples, and show how together they lead to comprehensive knowledge of existence.

Answer: Right understanding does not stay in the head — it moves through three stages:

1. Understanding: clarity in the intellect about 'what is true' — a conceptual, verbal grasp that you can explain in words. It happens in the intellect.

2. Realization: the same truth becomes your own direct experience, felt within the Self — beyond words. **Example (sugar):** reading that sugar is sweet — defining sweetness, describing its chemistry — is understanding; actually tasting the sugar, so that the sweetness becomes your own direct experience which no one can argue you out of, is realization. A student can 'understand' that honesty is important and score full marks explaining why, yet still copy in an exam; realization is when honesty is felt as one's own value.

3. Contemplation: sustained, deliberate reflection connecting what is understood and realized to your

own living and participation — asking: 'Given what I understand and have realized, what does this mean for how I act?' **Example (gravity):** you understand gravity as a law of mutual attraction (understanding); you feel your own weight and the pull of a fall, so it is no longer just a formula (realization); and you contemplate — you secure loose objects at height, design stairs with railings, walk carefully near edges — which shapes actual conduct.

Applied to existence: (1) **Realization of Co-Existence** — recognizing directly that 'I' and 'Nature' are not separate: my existence is already interconnected with the material, bio and human orders around me; it can be realized by tracing everything that had to exist for me to be here right now — air, food, people, parents — none of which is truly separate from me. (2) **Understanding of Harmony in Nature** — grasping how the four orders relate: each order fulfils the one below and is fulfilled by the one above, a chain of mutual fulfilment, not isolated survival. (3) **Contemplation of Participation** — reflecting on how 'I', as a human being with awareness and choice, actually take part in and carry forward this harmony: do my daily choices support or strain the balance between the orders? In my relationships, am I a fulfilling part of the whole? Will my professional work add to harmony or disturb it?

Together: understanding + realization + contemplation produce a comprehensive, livable knowledge of existence. The fragmented view (nature as a resource to use up; 'me' vs. 'the environment'; ethics as an external rule) gives way to the holistic view (nature as a web I am already part of; success including the fulfilment of the whole; ethics arising naturally from realized understanding).

Existence as Co-Existence and Mutual Fulfilment

Q4. Explain 'existence is co-existence' and mutual fulfilment among the four orders of nature.

Bring out the role of animals and birds in the bio order's fulfilment, self-regulation in nature, and the difference between units and space.

Answer: Existence is co-existence: existence is the co-existence of all units in space, related to one another in mutual fulfilment. Every unit — from an atom to a human being — is connected to and depends on other units; nothing exists in isolation. This shows up at every scale: physically, a tree cannot exist without soil, water, sunlight and air, and in turn releases the oxygen that sustains animal and human life; socially, an individual exists only in relationship (as someone's child, sibling, friend, student); societally, a farmer, teacher, doctor or engineer is not self-sufficient — society exists because each person's competence fulfils a need for everyone else. Nature is thus a collection of units — material, bio, animal and human — each understandable in terms of its constitution, its participation with other units, and its innateness.

Mutual fulfilment among the four orders: each order is fulfilling for the others in a continuous cycle — the soil (material order) provides minerals and water; plants (bio order) grow using soil, air and sunlight; animals and humans eat plants and breathe oxygen; and waste and remains return nutrients to the soil, so the cycle continues. Nothing is wasted and nothing stands alone. Harmony does not mean sameness — each distinct order plays its part in a way that supports and completes the others; disturb one order significantly (destroy soil health or forests) and the fulfilment of every other order, including the human order, is affected. The sequence of abundance also supports this: the material order is the most abundant, then bio, then animal, and the human order is the least abundant — the base naturally serves the top.

Role of animals and birds in the bio order's fulfilment: (1) pollination — bees, butterflies and birds carry pollen from flower to flower, enabling plants to reproduce (the honeybee collects nectar for itself while pollinating the flower, without either being harmed); (2) seed dispersal — birds eat fruits and disperse seeds over a wide area, helping new plants grow; (3) manure — animal waste returns nutrients to the soil, enriching it for plants. In return, plants provide animals and birds with food, shelter and oxygen.

Self-regulation in nature: the four orders inherently maintain harmony and balance among themselves without any external control — each unit takes only as much as it needs, and the cycles of nature (water cycle, food chains, nutrient cycles) run automatically. For example, in a forest, if the deer population grows, the food chain keeps it in check; a tiger kills only as much prey as it needs — animals never over-consume or hoard.

Units vs. space: in terms of size, every unit is limited — big or small, from an atom to the largest star — whereas space has no size; it is all-pervading and unlimited. In terms of activity, every unit is active, engaged in a definite continuous activity, whereas space is not active; it does nothing, interacts with nothing, is affected by nothing, and simply accommodates all the units. Existence is thus the co-existence of active units in all-pervading space — in harmony, not conflict.

The Human Order's Role and Responsibility

Q5. Explain the human order's unique responsibility in nature, the significance of education-sanskar for the human order, and what is meant by right utilisation, enrichment and protection of nature.

Answer: The human order's unique responsibility: a human being is the co-existence of the Self (the conscious 'I') and the Body (the material-biological unit). Only the human order can ask 'why?' — a plant grows and an animal acts by disposition, but only a human being can question, evaluate and choose whether an action is right. Because we alone can understand harmony, we alone are responsible for preserving or disturbing it: the other orders participate automatically, we participate consciously. Every professional decision — engineer, teacher, doctor — is a choice about sustaining or disrupting this harmony.

Harmony is a fact; participating in it is a choice: the material, plant and animal orders act spontaneously — they are automatically in harmony; a river does not choose to flow, a tree does not choose to grow towards light, and they cannot act otherwise. The human order has consciousness and choice — the freedom to select its actions — so harmony for us is not automatic; it must be understood, willed and lived.

Significance of education-sanskar: since the human order has choice (through the conscious Self with desire, thought and expectation), it can either participate in harmony or be in contradiction. Therefore the human order needs education-sanskar: education to develop right understanding of harmony at all levels — self, family, society and nature/existence — and sanskar to develop the basic acceptances of living accordingly. With education-sanskar, humans can fulfil their unique role in nature; without it, they remain in contradiction — exploiting nature, causing resource depletion, pollution and imbalance.

Right utilisation, enrichment and protection of nature: protection means safeguarding the continuity of nature — preventing deforestation, soil erosion and pollution of rivers; enrichment means improving the quantity and quality of nature — planting trees, water harvesting, composting; right utilisation means using natural resources according to real need, in limited quantity, for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body — not hoarding or wasting. **Example:** a farmer who rotates crops and lets soil recover is deliberately participating in nature's self-organising capacity; one who repeatedly over-extracts from the same land is in contradiction with it — even though the harm shows up only years later. These three together constitute the human order's true participation in the harmony of nature.

Human Participation in Harmony

Q6. 'Harmony is a fact; participating in it is a choice.' Explain the four kinds of human participation in harmony with everyday examples, and state why the comprehensive understanding of existence matters.

Answer: The material, plant and animal orders act spontaneously and are automatically in harmony — they cannot act otherwise. The human order alone has consciousness and choice, so harmony for us must be understood, willed and lived. Participation means choosing to act in line with the harmony that already exists.

The four kinds of human participation:

1. With the Self: keeping body and self in harmony — sleep, discipline, honest self-evaluation instead of distraction or self-neglect. A person acting in contradiction with the self lives in constant unease; participation brings inner ease.

2. With the family / society: right relationship — trust, respect and affection in the family, and contributing to society rather than only taking from it. Example: ignoring family to stay on the phone is contradiction; giving undivided time and attention at home is participation. The shared family meal — cooked and eaten together, everyone contributing, no one left out — is trust, respect and relationship in practice.

3. With nature: using material and biological resources responsibly — not wasting water, food or electricity in the hostel or at home. Example: leaving taps running is contradiction; using only what is needed and fixing leaks is participation. Littering the campus is contradiction; disposing of waste responsibly and segregating it is participation.

4. With existence as a whole: recognising that every choice ripples outward — a small daily habit either supports or disturbs the larger balance. Example: competing to put others down is contradiction; competing while respecting and helping peers is participation.

Comprehensive knowledge about existence is the outcome: seeing all four orders together with my own responsible place among them — existence as the co-existence of the four orders, related to one another in space in a mutually fulfilling, interconnected, self-regulating, recyclable relationship, with the human being, once aware, willingly participating in and upholding that harmony.

Why it matters: (1) Sustainability — it guides responsible use of natural resources instead of exploitative use; (2) family and social harmony — it grounds trust, respect and cooperation in relationships; (3) personal well-being — participation brings inner ease; and (4) it bridges to professional ethics (Module 5): one who can act in harmony personally can extend the same to one's future profession.

The Partial View vs. The Comprehensive View of Existence

Q7. What is meant by existence? Distinguish between the partial (fragmented) view and the comprehensive view of nature, with real-world examples of the consequences of each.

Answer: Existence is everything that is — all material things, all living beings, and the space in which they exist, all functioning together as one interrelated whole. It is comprehensive, interconnected and self-organised — not a random collection of separate objects.

The partial (fragmented) view: sees nature as separate objects — rocks, trees, animals, humans — unrelated to each other; treats humans as separate from or superior to nature, free to exploit it; studies each thing in isolation (a tree, a river, a mineral) without seeing the relationship between them; and leads to fragmented, short-term decisions such as pollution, deforestation and resource depletion.

The comprehensive view: sees nature as one interconnected, self-organised whole in which every part is related to every other part; understands the human being as an integral part of nature, participating in it rather than standing outside it; recognises four distinct orders (Material, Bio, Animal, Human), each with its own role, working together; and leads to harmony, sustainability and right participation — the basis for a value-based life.

Real-world consequences of the two views:

(1) **Deforestation for short-term profit:** the partial view sees trees only as timber/land value; the comprehensive view sees trees as sustaining soil, the water cycle, animal life and climate.

(2) **River pollution by industry:** the partial view sees the river only as a waste-disposal channel; the comprehensive view sees it as part of a living system supporting agriculture, drinking water and biodiversity.

(3) **Overuse of chemical fertilisers:** the partial view sees soil only as a medium for higher yield; the comprehensive view sees it as a living order needing long-term care for future generations.

(4) **Species extinction:** the partial view sees one species' loss as unrelated to us; the comprehensive view sees that every order's loss disturbs the interconnected balance that humans also depend on.

Thus, the partial view causes real harm — resource depletion, pollution, loss of biodiversity — while the comprehensive view is the basis of sustainable, value-based living and of the human being's right participation in existence.

Illustrations from Everyday Life and the Reference Readings

Q8. Explain harmony in nature and human participation with the help of everyday illustrations — the honeybee and the flower, the human body, crop rotation vs. over-farming, and the shared family meal. Also discuss the insights of E. F. Schumacher, Ivan Illich and Susan George.

Answer: 1. The honeybee and the flower: the bee collects nectar for itself (its own need) while pollinating the flower in the process — the animal order fulfils the plant order without either being harmed. It shows that nature's orders participate in mutual fulfilment automatically: self-interest and the other's fulfilment are not in conflict in nature.

2. The human body — all four orders in one: the body's atoms follow the material order; its cells grow and heal like the bio/plant order; its organs function like the animal order; and only you — the human order — can be aware of all this and choose. The body is thus a living example of the co-existence of the four orders.

3. Crop rotation vs. over-farming: a farmer who rotates crops and lets the soil recover is deliberately participating in nature's self-organising capacity (enrichment and protection of the material and bio orders); one who repeatedly over-extracts from the same land is in contradiction with it — even though the harm (soil degradation) shows up only years later. The two show the difference between participation and contradiction in the human order's relationship with nature.

4. The shared family meal: an ordinary daily meal cooked and eaten together — everyone contributing, no one served last or left out — is trust, respect and relationship in practice. It shows the same harmony logic scaled up from the self to the family and society: mutual fulfilment at the level of relationship.

Insights from the reference readings:

(1) **E. F. Schumacher — 'Small is Beautiful' (1973)**: argues that economics built on ever-larger scale and unlimited resource use loses sight of human-scale, sustainable living — ignoring mutual fulfilment with the material and bio orders; it illustrates the consequence of a partial, exploitative view of nature.

(2) **Ivan Illich — 'Energy and Equity' (1974)**: shows that, past a point, more energy consumption creates inequity rather than progress — a caution about over-drawing on the material order without balance.

(3) **Susan George — 'How the Other Half Dies' (1976)**: examines how food scarcity is often not about nature's limits but about unequal, non-fulfilling participation among human beings — harmony broken within the human order itself.

Conclusion: these illustrations show that harmony in nature is real and observable everywhere — in the flower and the bee, in our own body, on the farm, and at the dining table. Nature's orders participate in mutual fulfilment automatically; the human order alone can either sustain this harmony through right participation or disturb it through contradiction. The readings warn what happens when the partial view drives human systems — and thereby underline why the comprehensive understanding of existence matters.